# Juan S. Gómez Cruces, Ph.D.

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## Academic Positions

2024–2026 | **Universität Potsdam/Hasso-Plattner Institut**
Post-Doctoral Researcher in Digital Technologies, Democratic Governance and Policy

## Education

2024 | **Georgia State University**
Ph.D. Political Science
Subfields: Comparative Politics and Research Methods

2017 | **University of Colorado, Denver**
M.A. Political Science

2007 | **Instituto Tecnológico y de Estudios Superiores de Monterrey**
B.A. International Relations

## Research Interests

**Substantive:** Digital technology, democratic institutions, populism and democratic erosion, Latin American politics.
**Methodological:** Computational social science, causal inference, and survey experiments.

## Publications

2025 | McCoy, Jennifer, Juan S. Gómez-Cruces, Ozlem Tuncel, & Levente Littvay. "Reducing Partisan Animus in Populist Contexts: Limitations of Shared Common Humanity and Perspective-Taking Interventions." Chapter 14 in *The Ideational Approach to Populism: Consequences and Mitigation*, edited by Angelos Chryssogelos, Kirk A. Hawkins, Eliza Tanner Hawkins, Levente Littvay, & Nina Wiesehomeier. Routledge Series: Extremism & Democracy.

2024 | Gómez-Cruces, Juan S. "Forecasting executive approval with social media data: opportunities, challenges and limitations." *Journal of Computational Social Science* (2024). https://doi.org/10.1007/s42001-024-00299-y

2022 | Carlin, Ryan E. & Juan S. Gómez-Cruces. "Trust in Latin American Governing Institutions." In *Oxford Bibliographies in Political Science*. Ed. Sandy Maisel. New York: Oxford University Press.

## Working Papers

"Automated Political Stance Identification in Political Texts: A Transparent, Reproducible, Scalable and Theory-Driven Approach" (Revise-and-Resubmit at *Political Science Research and Methods*)
"Dividing, but Not Conquering: Populist Online Communication in Latin America" (Under review)
"Assessing the Impact of Populists in Power on Digital Governance"
"Interactions with Populist Leaders in Latin America on Social Media: A text-classification analysis using Large Language Models"
"Populists in Power and Their Online Engagement: Evidence from Presidential Twitter in Latin America"

## Conference Papers

"Automated Political Stance Identification in Political Texts." Accepted at the *RC33 11th International Social Science Methodology Conference*, Naples, Italy, September 2025.
"The Effects of Populist Rule on Internet Freedom." Accepted at the *2025 European Political Science Association Conference*, Madrid, Spain, June 2025.
"Interactions with Populist Leaders in Latin America on Social Media: A text-classification analysis using Large Language Models." Presented at the *2024 Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting*, New Orleans, LA.
"Populist Rhetoric Depiction of Elites: Shadowy yet Ubiquitous?" (with Adrien Halliez). Presented at the *2024 Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting*, New Orleans, LA.
"Forecasting Executive Approval with Social Media Data: Opportunities, Challenges and Limitations." Presented at the *2023 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting*, Los Angeles, CA.
"Populists in power and online engagement with the components of populist rhetoric on social media. Evidence from Latin America." Presented at *2023 International Congress of the Latin American Studies Association* in Vancouver, BC.
"Are Social Media Eroding Political Trust in Institutions in Latin America?" Presented at the *2019 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting*, Washington, D.C.

## Policy Reports

2025 | Gómez-Cruces, J., Ranger, J., Jan, U., Thomas-Colquhoun, E. and de la Paz, E. *Path to Power: 2024 – The 2024 Mexican General Election.* (2024.3) Hasso-Plattner-Institut für Digital Engineering GmbH, Universität Potsdam.
De la Paz, E., Ranger, J., Gomez-Cruces, J., Jan, U., & Thomas-Colquhoun, E. *Path to Power 2024: Global Democracy in the Age of Disruption.* (2024) Hasso-Plattner-Institut für Digital Engineering GmbH, Universität Potsdam.

## Software & Digital Tools

2026 | **Executive Social Media Database (ESMD)**

Open dataset of 498,605 posts and engagement metrics from 62 heads of government and state across 34 countries, 2009–2023. Includes a browser application running SQL, a Python package, and an R package. ESMD web application. Code

2026 **Automated Political Stance Identifier (APSI)**
Team Leader. Open-source, theory-driven NLP tool for zero-shot political stance detection. APSI web application. Code.

## Grants, Fellowships & Awards

2024-2026 *Digital Technology, Governance and Policy Post-Doctoral Researcher*, Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) Grant, "Path to Power Project".

2022-2024 *Executive Approval Project Advanced Research Assistant*, National Science Foundation grant, "Public Support in Challenging Times: Varieties of Crises, Elite Responses, and Executive Approval" SES #2116467.

2022 *Atlanta Area Computational Social Science Data Showcase Award*, Emory University, Atlanta, GA.
*Summer Research and Professional Development Fellowship*, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA.

2020–2021 *Graduate Research Fellow for the Democracy Program*, The Carter Center, Atlanta, GA.
*Foreign Doctoral Scholarship*, Consejo Nacional de Ciencia y Tecnología, Mexico
*Complement Scholarship*, Secretaría de Educación Pública, Mexico.

## Teaching Experience

2025 **Universität Potsdam/Hasso-Plattner Institut**
Instructor. Large Language Models (LLMs) for Social Research

2021–2022 **Georgia State University**
Instructor. Global Issues

2017 **Instituto Tecnológico y de Estudios Superiores de Monterrey**
Lecturer. Civil Society and Participation

2016–2018 **Universidad Abierta y a Distancia de México**
Instructor. Comparative Public Administration (four semesters, online)

## Mentoring

2024–2026 **Universität Potsdam/Hasso-Plattner Institut**
Co-supervisor of a master's thesis in computer science; mentored a master's student and a doctoral student in the development of APSI.

2020–2024 **Georgia State University**
Recruited, trained, and supervised ten research assistants across five Latin American countries.

## Methods Training and Workshops

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| Expected May 2027 | *Graduate Certificate in Latin American Studies*, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA |
| 2026 | *Large Language Models for Social Science*, Spring School in Advanced Research Methods, Oxford University, Oxford, UK. |
| 2024 | *Introduction to Methods of Causal Inference*, GESIS, Leibniz-Institut für Sozialwissenschaften. |
| 2022 | *Summer Institute in Computational Social Science*, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA. |
| | *Winter School on Variations in Populism*, Arab Center for Research and Policy Studies, Doha, Qatar. |
| 2021 | *Computational Social Science Workshop and Datathon*, Emory University, Georgia Institute of Technology, and University of Georgia. |
| 2020 | *Machine Learning with Big Data for Social Scientists*, European Consortium for Political Research, Methods School, Central European University. |
| 2019 | *Summer School on Political Behavior in Latin America*, European Consortium for Political Research, Segovia, Spain. |

## Reviewer Service

*Political Communication, Comparative Political Studies, Journal of Information Technology & Politics, Latin American Research Review, Revista Latinoamericana de Opinión Pública, International Journal of Public Opinion Research*

## Relevant Professional Experience

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| 2025–present | **Democracy Reporting International**<br>Digital Democracy Expert<br>Berlin, Germany |
| 2017–2024 | **Institute for Development, Evaluation, Assistance & Solutions**<br>Institutional Relations Consultant<br>Decatur, GA, USA |

## Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (reading proficiency), French (reading proficiency), German (A1).

## Programming & Data Skills

Python (advanced), R (advanced), SQL (intermediate); machine learning and LLMs, NLP, web scraping (Selenium), API-based data collection; Git/GitHub, Docker, reproducible research workflows; LaTeX, Qualtrics.